

All user-centric files such as documents, photos, music, videos, etc. are stored under 'C:\Users\' which should have a separate folder for each user account on your computer. Note that it isn't compulsory to save all your files here, if you have also saved files elsewhere you will have to back those up as well.

Let's assume that as a cruel joke, your parents named you 'User Name' and that's what your login id is on Windows. You will find your data under: 'C:\Users\User Name\'

Inside that folder most folder names should be self-explanatory, they have names like Pictures, Downloads, Desktop, Documents etc. Some other applications might have created their own folders here, if you want to be safe back those up as well.

There is however a hidden folder here called 'AppData' that could also have some data of importance. This folder contains application data for installed applications, such as your Browser profiles, game save files, and other settings and configuration files. If you want to save these files, you will have to dig into this folder.

Within 'AppData' you will find two or three folders, 'Local' and 'Roaming' should definitely be there. Here applications are supposed to use the 'Local' folder to store data that can be regenerated, such as your browser cache and other less important data. Back up the 'Roaming' folder for your profiles at least. If not all of it, then at least the applications that you think are important.

Just to clarify this folder is at 'C:\Users\User Name\AppData'. You can enter that path in the location bar to get to this folder since it is hidden, or just enable display of hidden files.

All of the above info can also be useful if you want to get existing data out of an existing 'Windows.old' folder. Your files there will be in 'C:\Windows.old\Users\User Name\'.

Rolling back to earlier Windows

Remember that 'Windows.old' folder we mentioned earlier? This is where it gets really important. If you upgraded to Windows 10 from a previous version, this folder will be around for 30 days. And if it's around chances are you can simply perform a rollback.

Open the new Settings app by clicking on 'Settings' on the start menu, or searching for settings using the new search bar in Windows 10. Click the "Update & security" icon and select the "Recovery" option. In case your operating system is eligible to move back to older versions of Windows,